

10. Does this checkin include any breaking of backward compatibility of the earlier versions of this software?
11. Does this checkin change any existing error message numbers?
12. Have you added comments/documentation for your changes?
13. Have you checked that any pointers which are getting dereferenced cannot be NULL?
14. Does this checkin add any new function?
 - a. If so, have all possible return values been handled in caller?
 - b. If they have, does it return meaningful error return values?
 - c. Do you have unit test cases that cover various return values?
15. Does this code read/modify any globals/shared variables?
 - a. If so, can it be called from multiple threads?
 - b. If it can, do you have proper locking to prevent races?

As a developer, please start maintaining your own code review checklist. You also need to keep track of how effective your code reviews are. The effectiveness of the code review can be measured in terms of both the number of defects that are found during the review and also by the number of defects that escape the code review process. Start tracking these metrics for the code you review so that you can see how effective your reviews are.

My 'must-read book' for this month

This month's suggestion comes from me and it is one of my own books that I want to recommend, specifically for college students who are preparing for campus interviews.

The book is titled 'Cracking the system software interview' and is available through Flipkart as well as in various bookstores. It covers typical interview questions on operating systems, data structures, algorithms, computer architecture, etc. If you have a few days to refresh your fundamentals in time for an interview, this is an ideal book to browse through.

If you have a favourite programming book/article that you think is a must-read for every programmer, please do send me a note with the book's name, and a short write-up on why you think it is useful so I can mention it in this column. This would help many readers who want to improve their software skills.

If you have any favourite programming questions/software topics that you would like to discuss on this forum, please send them to me, along with your solutions and feedback, at sandyasm_AT_yahoo_DOT_com. Till we meet again next month, happy programming and here's wishing you the very best! 

By: Sandya Mannarswamy

The author is an expert in systems software and is currently working with Hewlett Packard India Ltd. Her interests include compilers, multi-core and storage systems. If you are preparing for systems software interviews, you may find it useful to visit Sandya's LinkedIn group *Computer Science Interview Training India* at <http://www.linkedin.com/groups?home=HYPERLINK> "<http://www.linkedin.com/group/s?home=&gid=2339182>" & *HYPERLINK* "<http://www.linkedin.com/groups?home=&gid=2339182>"

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